

Finance Committee Meeting October 16th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WKHgYS0itrA
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Finance Committee

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript begins directly with the regular meeting proceedings; no separate pre-meeting public hearings or separate committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at [00:00:24](#) as the final 2025 finance committee meeting. The presiding officer noted that the meeting is kept informal primarily because nine members cannot meet without it constituting an open meeting, providing an opportunity to touch base on the 2025 budget.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officer / Chair:** Council Member Norah
 - **Staff Present:** The Controller (Mr. Craig / Mr. Wright)
 - **Other Noted Participants:** Chief Burford (Fire Department)
 - **Absent / Unnamed Members:** Other members of the finance committee and council were present for discussion, though individual roll-call attendance was not

explicitly read into the record.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with members standing to recite the Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:24.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** There was no mention or action regarding the approval of prior meeting minutes.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:00:46 **2025 Budget Review & General Fund Discussion**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Committee Chair Council Member Norah, joined by Controller Craig/Wright and Fire Chief Burford.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The committee reviewed the status of the 2025 budget. Initially, the budget faced an approximate \$1.7 million deficit over expected revenues. Calculations using Department of Local Government Finance (DLGF) forms indicated the general fund would start with a deficit of nearly \$250,000 on January 1, 2025.
 - Key adjustments discussed to close the gap include:
 - Correction of two budget errors identified by Mayor Ridenour: an over-budgeted Board of Works health insurance line item by \$1,213,434, and an under-reporting of interest revenue (item R902) by \$520,000.
 - A voluntary forfeiture of \$223,000 back to the general fund by the Muncie Police Department.
 - A voluntary reduction proposed by Fire Chief Burford regarding their PERF (Public Employees' Retirement Fund) line item.
 - The committee also discussed ongoing union contract negotiations (police, fire, and AFSCME) and the financial constraints of a razor-thin general fund. Controller Craig/Wright confirmed that a 5% raise was budgeted in 2024 for civilian employees, and that future budgeting aims to shift general fund utilities and health insurance expenses entirely under the Board of Works/Controller's office for easier tracking.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None (committee work session format).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review only; no formal vote taken on the budget during this segment.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No open public comment period or citizen forum took place during this meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Members were instructed to review the tabled salary ordinance (Ordinance 12-24, introduced around June/July) to verify civilian salary baselines and apply a 1% increase figure for potential savings.
 - Council members were reminded by the Chair that any member has the right to propose individual budget amendments.
 - **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made and accepted (00:29:54), though the formal voice vote or gavel was cut off mid-sentence before roll call could be finalized.
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